

Sweat

SWEAT STRATEGIES — INVESTMENT DECK

WHAT WE ARE

Music marketing, measured.

We test every part of a record against real audiences before anyone spends at scale, then put the budget behind the version that already won. The output is a cost per result a label can plan against.

DISCLOSURE



THUNDERCAT



WHY NOW

A record no longer needs anyone's permission.

01

The audience can be bought directly

Two of the campaigns in this deck went from nothing on release day to 18,000 and 25,000 streams a day inside three weeks. A third was a debut from an artist with no social media at all.

02

And the catalogue can be reopened

An eleven-year-old record moved 4.3 million streams in 28 days with no new recording behind it. Catalogue does not decay on its own — it decays when nobody works it.

03

But it is still bought on opinion

The money moved and the method did not. Most of it is still spent on a handful of edits somebody liked, with no read on whether another would have worked better.

A few edits go out. Nobody ever finds out whether a different one would have worked better.

That is not a criticism of anyone's team — it is what the workflow allows. Assets arrive, spend goes behind them, and the numbers come back after the money has gone. When it underperforms there is no way to tell whether it was the record, the audience or the edit, because only a handful ever ran.

THE PRODUCT

(We sell measurement)

HOW IT WORKS

We don't launch creative. We find out which creative works, then launch that.

A campaign starts as an experiment costing a couple of hundred and finishes as a scaling decision made on arithmetic. The expensive part of music marketing is not the media — it is spending it behind the wrong thirty seconds.

01

Test the song

Every section of the record against a control visual, so the hook is measured rather than chosen.

02

Build to the winner

Up to twenty-five variants cut to the winning sound, from the audio alone, run against each other until the cost stops falling.

03

Read the country

Cost per result weighed against how much each market actually listens. Cheapest and most valuable are rarely the same place.

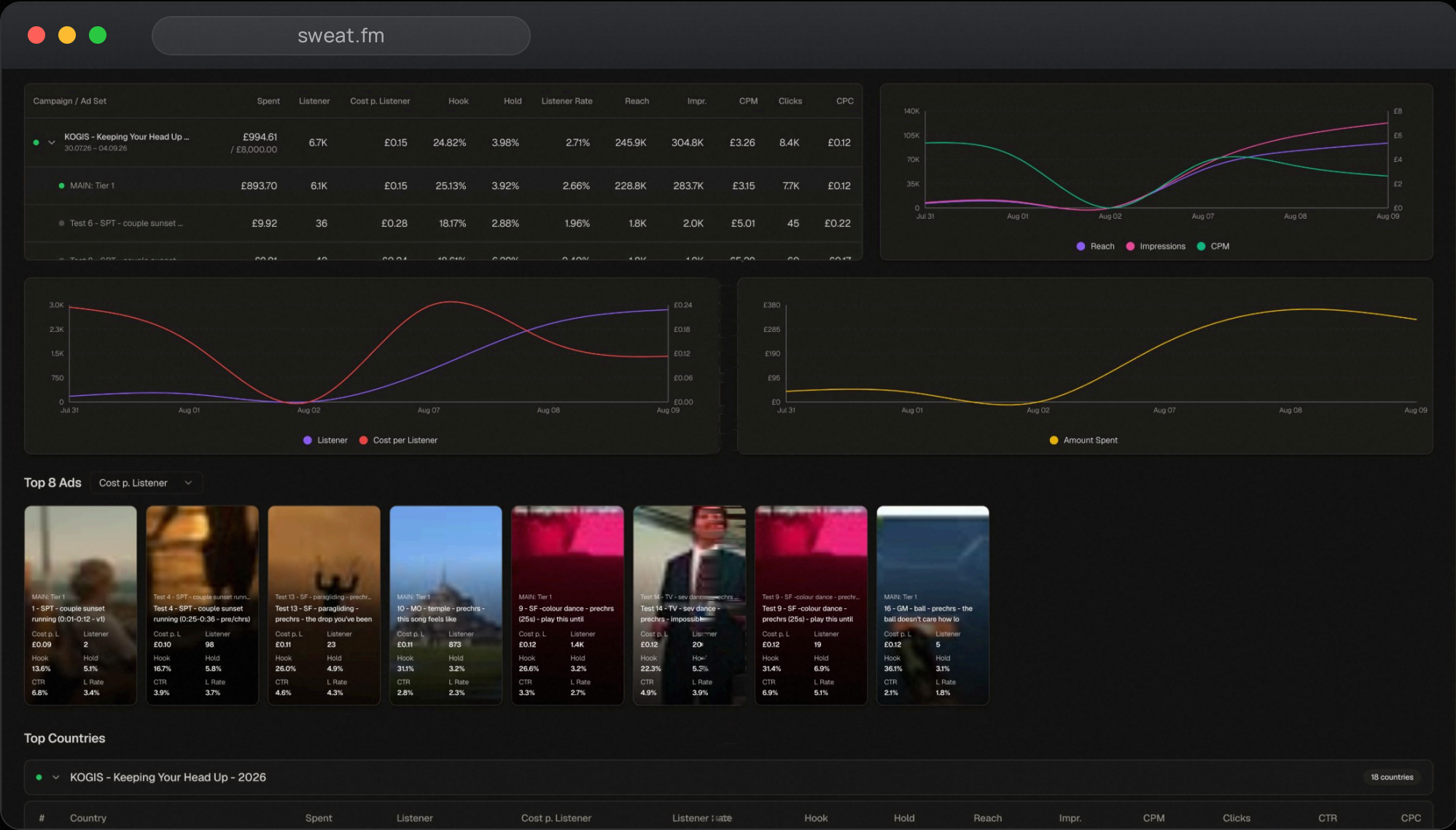
04

Scale, or stop

A read in 72 hours. Most records don't earn the budget, and saying so early is the service.

A dashboard, daily.
Every record on it.

Sweat.fm is our own platform rather than a third-party dashboard. Every test, every cost per result, every market, updated daily. Creative comes to the client as a link — they click approve and the system does the rest.

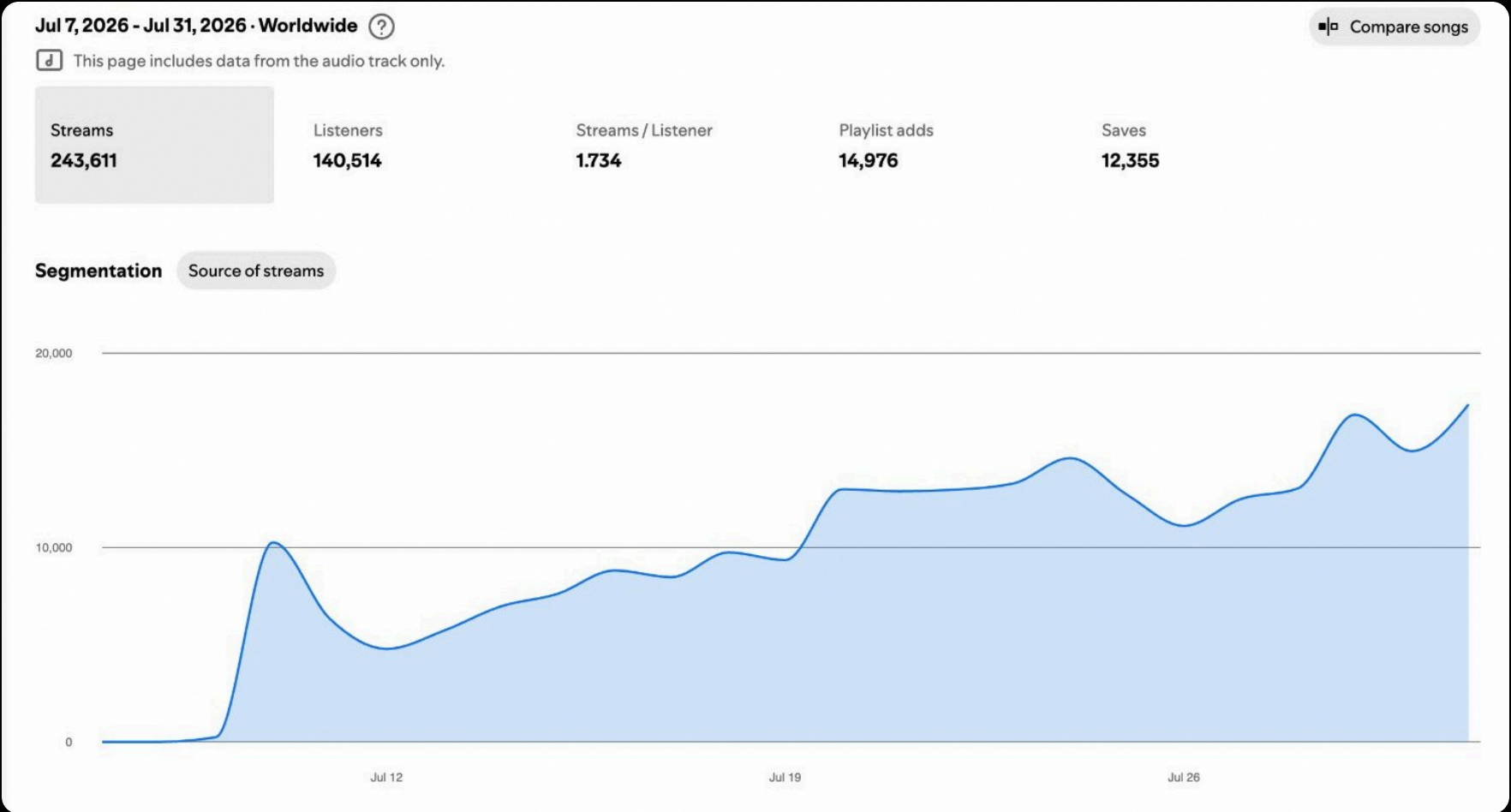


DANCE SINGLE · FIRST THREE WEEKS

0 to 18K daily streams in 3 weeks.

£3K spend · 12p CPR

A cold start on a dance record: 243,611 streams to 140,514 listeners, with fifteen thousand playlist adds and twelve thousand saves inside the first three weeks.

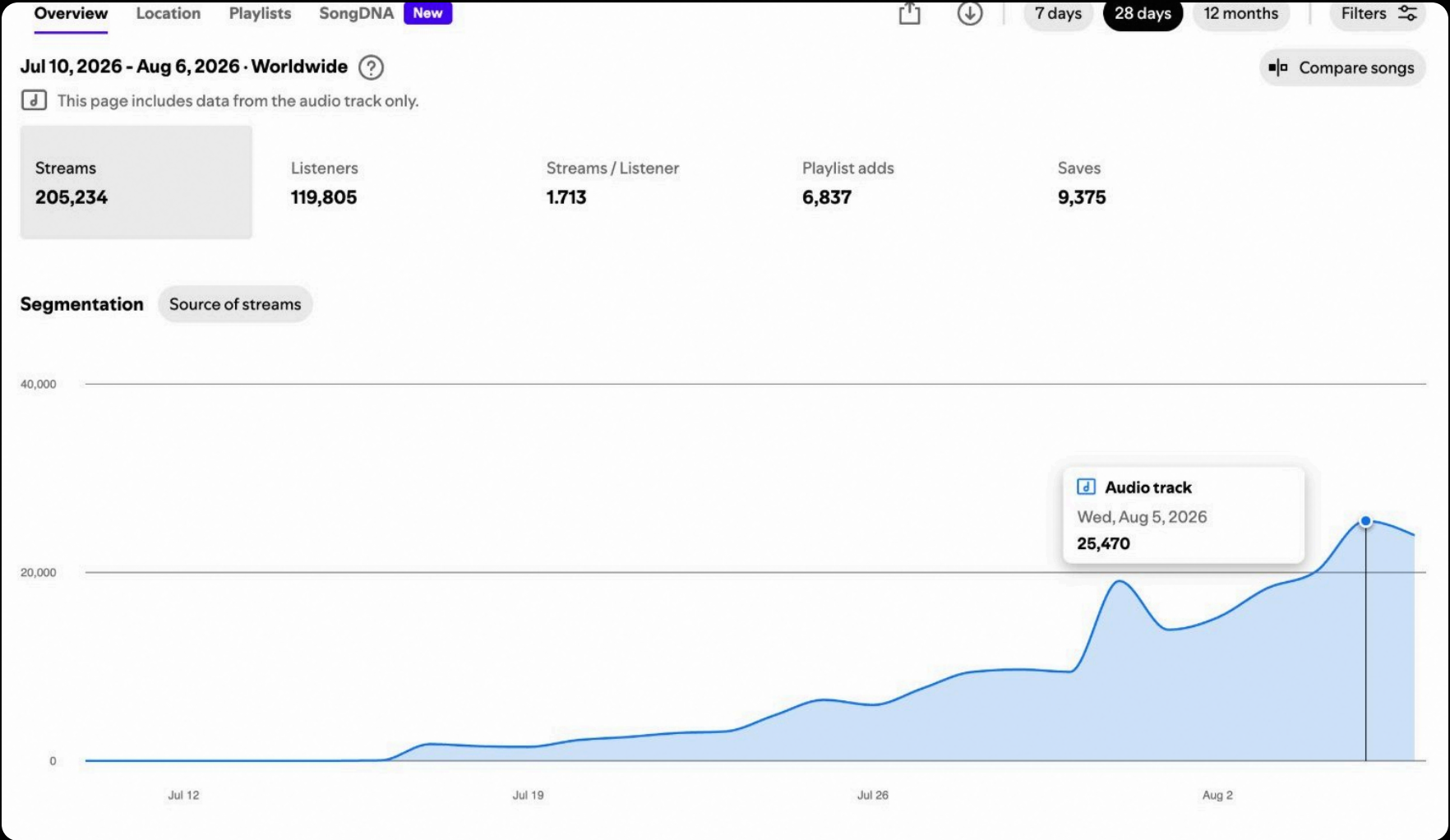


SINGLE · FIRST THREE WEEKS

0 to 25K daily streams in 3 weeks.

£4.5K spend · 15p CPR

Nothing on release day and 25,470 a day three weeks later, for 205,234 streams in total. The line only bends once the spend finds the audience that responds.



THE SAME MACHINE, POINTED ELSEWHERE

Streams are the wedge. They are not the business.

A cheap stream is easy to sell and easy to prove, which is how we get in. But an audience that has been found and measured converts to things worth considerably more than a stream, and the campaign that does it is the same campaign.

TOURING ARTIST · TICKETING · £

5,000 tickets
on £6K of spend.

GROSS TICKET REVENUE RETURN ON AD SPEND

£66K 11:1

Awareness built on DSP ads, converted by retargeting the fans already listening.

MERCH · TWO WEEKS · \$

\$68K of merch
on \$6K of spend.

CAMPAIGN LENGTH RETURN ON AD SPEND

2 wks 11:1

A streaming audience converted into buyers, on the same accounts and the same method.

THE BUSINESS

(Who already buys it)

ARTISTS

Swedish House Mafia · Disclosure · Bonobo · Maribou State · Thundercat · Elderbrook · Barry Can't Swim · Kerri Chandler · Blond:Ish · Carlita · Mark Tuan · Leon Thomas · Omar+ · St Lundi · ADMT · Harry T · Cristoph · Sam Alfred · Gaskin · The Listros · KOGIS · Ruthanne · Ethan Walsh · Kid Apollo · Boy Loco · Dolores Forever · The Knocks · Rules · Morly · Scout · Ormella

LABELS & PARTNERS

- Atlantic Records
- BMG
- Ninja Tune
- Live Nation
- CAA
- SJM
- Disorder
- Propeller
- Redlight
- Too Lost
- 3000 Years
- Funfair
- Circuit Group
- Chosen Music

Campaign figures in this deck are anonymised. The artists and partners above are published on sweatstrategies.com.

HOW WE MAKE MONEY

A retainer to think, a percentage to scale.

Clients pay a monthly fee that covers testing, creative and reporting, plus a commission on the media we scale once a record has earned it. The fee makes the revenue predictable; the commission means we are paid more when the client spends more, and the client only spends more when something is working.

01**Recurring by default**

Labels release continuously, so the work is a standing operation rather than a project. Retainers run monthly or quarterly.

02**Upside tied to results**

Commission on scaled media only. A campaign we stop early costs the client nothing more and costs us nothing to have run.

03**Priced per test, not per hour**

The unit is a record tested, which is why the same team can carry many more clients than a headcount model would allow.

WHERE WE ARE • TO BE SUPPLIED

Where the trading figures sit.

[TBC]

ANNUAL RUN RATE

[TBC]

GROWTH, YEAR ON YEAR

[TBC]

CLIENTS ON RETAINER

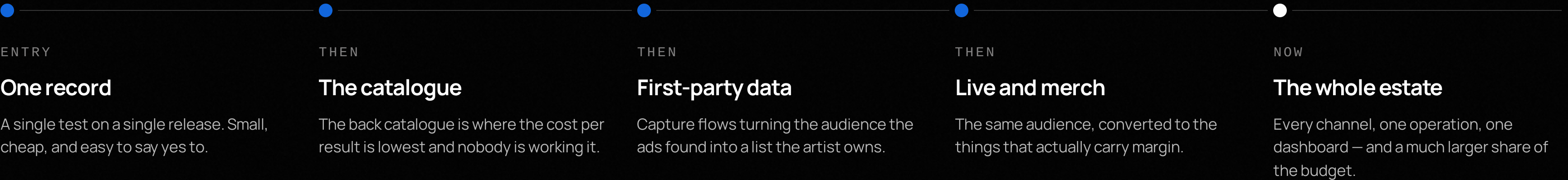
[TBC]

NET REVENUE RETENTION

These four come out of Sweat's own accounts and are left blank in this draft rather than estimated — an estimate here is the first thing to come apart in diligence. Everything else in this deck is checkable: the roster, the partners and every campaign figure are real and documented.

HOW AN ACCOUNT GROWS

We arrive on one record
and end up on the estate.



Each step is already running somewhere on the book: the catalogue cases, the capture flows, the ticketing and the merch campaign are all in this deck. What the next slide sizes is how much of that estate there is to go at.

THE MARKET · INPUTS TO CONFIRM

Sized from what one release actually costs.

Built upwards from a release rather than downwards from an industry total. Four inputs, each one confirmable from our own book and from the terms we already sell on.

01
[TBC]

Releases a year

Inside the labels, distributors and management companies we already sell to.

02
[TBC]

That carry a budget

The share of them with real marketing money behind them rather than a post and a hope.

03
[TBC]

Spend per release

What one release absorbs in testing and scaled media across its window.

04
[TBC]

Share we can hold

The three above multiplied, then the part of it one operation can actually run.

What we can already anchor: the campaigns in this deck ran on anything from £1,500 a month against a catalogue album to £22,000 across a single EP window, and one US account sustained \$1,000–\$3,000 a month for six months.

WHO DOES IT

One team, and one person accountable.

Peter Jarrett ORCHESTRATOR

Sits above every campaign and is accountable for the operation as a whole — the plan, the partners and the commercial terms.

Senior Marketing Director

Tobias Steinborn

Holds the campaigns across clients and partners, and owns the weekly rhythm every account runs to.

Campaign Strategist

Oskar

Designs what gets tested, against whom, and what each result changes about the next release.

Paid media

Holly

Daily hands on the accounts — building the tests, killing what fails, scaling what clears.

TRACK RECORD & HEADCOUNT

[TBC]

What each of them ran before this, and who else is on payroll. Worth writing properly — for most investors the team slide is the one that decides it.

THE RAISE

(What the money does)

THE NEXT EIGHTEEN MONTHS

More accounts, and more of each account.

01

Sell the estate, not the record

The existing accounts are the cheapest growth available. Ticketing, merch and first-party data are already built and already proven inside them.

03

Sweat.fm as the surface

Clients already approve creative and read results there. It is the part of the business that looks least like an agency and most like software.

02

Productise the testing

Creative is already built from the audio alone — up to twenty-five pieces per release. The further that goes, the more records one strategist can carry, which is the whole margin question.

04

Depth in electronic, then out

The roster is concentrated in dance and electronic, which is where the method was proven. The catalogue cases show it travels.

USE OF FUNDS

Three places,
in this order.

[TBC]

ENGINEERING

The creative system and sweat.fm — the two things that decide how many records one person can carry.

[TBC]

STRATEGISTS

Client capacity is the binding constraint on new business today, and strategists are what relieves it.

[TBC]

WORKING CAPITAL

Media is frequently fronted before it is recovered. Growth in an agency is largely a cash-timing problem.

The three headings are the argument and they hold whatever the split turns out to be. The percentages are set with the round.

THE ASK

What we are raising,
and what closes it.

[TBC]

AMOUNT

[TBC]

INSTRUMENT

[TBC]

VALUATION

[TBC]

COMMITTED SO FAR

This deck does not go out with this slide unfinished. Amount, instrument, valuation and what is already committed are the four things a reader checks first, and they are the four this draft does not yet carry.

The evidence is already written down.

Every campaign figure in this deck comes off a screenshot we can show you, on accounts you can be walked through live. The quickest way to test whether any of this is real is to ask for that walkthrough.

01

A session in the ad accounts and in sweat.fm, with the back end open.

02

The client book, the contracts and the accounts.

03

The trading figures, and the terms.

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